

Paper 3, Option 36.1:

Protest, agitation and parliamentary reform in Britain, c1780–1928

Overview

This option comprises two parts: the *Aspects in breadth* focus on long-term changes and contextualise the *Aspects in depth*, which focus in detail on key episodes.

Together, the breadth and depth topics explore the relationship between authority and mass agitation in England, the struggle for greater representation in England, and the ways in which the interests and concerns of individuals in society could make themselves known. Within the primarily political focus, this option also gives students the opportunity to explore the economic and social contexts and their influence on developments and on the pressures for change.

Aspects in breadth: changes in representation in England, c1780–1928	
Themes	Content
1 Reform of parliament	- Changes in the franchise, c1780–1928: the franchise c1780 and its significance for representation of the people; pressures for change and reasons for resistance (key developments: the Representation of the People Acts of 1832, 1867, 1884, 1918 and 1928). - Reform and redistribution, c1780–1928: the problems of representation c1780; the failure of Pitt's proposals; reasons for resistance to, and key changes brought by, reform (key developments: Representation of the People Acts 1832–1928, Redistribution Act 1885, the Ballot Act 1872, the Corrupt Practices Act 1883); the extent of change by 1928.
2 Changing influences in parliament: the impact of parliamentary reform	- The influence of the crown and aristocracy, c1780–1928: the extent of crown and aristocratic influence on elections and in parliament c1780; the reasons for declining influence over the House of Commons (key developments: 'economical reform' in the 1780s, the Parliament Act 1911). - Changes in political parties, c1780–1928: their role in parliament and in elections; party organisation and membership; the growth of the Labour Party. The extent of change in the social makeup of the House of Commons by 1928 (key developments: abolition of property qualification 1858, payment of MPs 1911).

Aspects in depth: mass protest and agitation	
Key topics	Content
1 Radical reformers, c1790–1819	- Aims, tactics and impact of extra-parliamentary protest: the London Corresponding Society, 1792–93, the Spa Fields meetings, 1816, the Pentridge Rising, 1817, and Peterloo, 1819; extent of success by 1819. - Government responses: the trial of the leaders of the London Corresponding Society and suspension of Habeas Corpus, 1794, the Treason Act and Seditious Meetings Act 1795, the Gagging Acts 1817 and the Six Acts 1819. - The influence of Tom Paine and the <i>Rights of Man</i>, John Cartwright and the Hampden Clubs, William Cobbett and the Political Register; the role of Henry Hunt as a radical orator.
2 Chartism, c1838–c1850	- Chartism's aims and actions; importance of the National Convention, 1839, the Newport Rising, 1839, the Petitions (1839, 1842, 1848) and the Kennington Common rally, 1848; the roles of Lovett and O'Connor; reasons why Chartism failed to achieve its aims by 1850. - Fluctuations in support among different sections of society, and reasons for this. - Government responses; the significance of Major General Napier; the impact of the growth of a rail network.
3 Contagious Diseases Acts and the campaign for their repeal, 1862–86	- Reasons why the Contagious Diseases Acts were introduced, including the committee established in 1862 to look into extent of venereal disease in the armed forces. - The Acts' impact on prostitutes and ordinary women. - The roles of Josephine Butler and Elizabeth Wolstenholme and the significance of Ladies' Association for the Repeal of the Contagious Diseases Act; reasons for the Acts' repeal.
4 The Women's Social and Political Union, 1903–14	- WSPU organisation and tactics; extent of support; the reasons for, and impact of, increased militancy after 1908. - The roles of Emily Davison and Christabel, Emmeline and Sylvia Pankhurst; extent of the WSPU's success by 1914. - Government attitudes to female suffrage and WSPU; reasons for the failure of the Women's Suffrage bill 1909, the Conciliation Committee and the Conciliation bills 1910 and 1911, and the Government Franchise bill 1913.
5 Trades union militancy, 1915–27	- The roles of Manny Shinwell, James Maxton, Ernest Bevin and J H Thomas; the events and significance of the Glasgow rent strike, 1915, and the 40-hour strike, 1919. - Union revival after the First World War: the Triple Alliance; the impact of Black Friday, 1921; the importance of the Council of Action and the formation of the AEU and TGWU.